

do not encrypt it. Using this command can produce unexpected results and cause unrecoverable damage.

Firewall

A firewall prevents computers on a network from communicating directly with external computer systems. A firewall typically consists of a computer that acts as a barrier through which all information passing between the networks and the external systems must travel. The firewall software analyses information passing between the two and rejects it if it does not conform to pre-configured rules.

Germ

A first generation sample of a virus. Technically, the term is reserved for forms of the virus that are in some way 'special', such that another sample could not be produced as the result of a normal infection event.

Ghost Positive

This is a specific form of false positive, in which the error is due to 'leftover pieces' or 'remnants' of a virus that are incorrectly detected and reported as an infection. As the virus is not present or present but inactive, it is erroneous for a scanner to report an infection.

Globbering

Globbering is the use of wildcard characters or arguments to greatly increase the amount of data requested. An example is "dir *.*" in DOS, this command is asking for all file names with all file extensions (everything) in the current directory. By making globbering requests to a Web server it is sometimes possible to cause a Denial of Service attack as the server is too busy to deal with legitimate requests.

Heuristic Analysis, Heuristic Scan

This is Behaviour-based analysis of a computer program by anti-virus software to identify a potential virus. Often heuristic scanning produces false alarms when a clean program might behave as a virus.